

TOAI Official Regulations

Turkic Olympiad in Artificial Intelligence
Version 1.0 — Valid for TOAI 2026 Istanbul

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1 Article 1 — General Provisions

1.1 Name and Identity

The Turkic Olympiad in Artificial Intelligence (hereinafter referred to as “TOAI” or “the Olympiad”) is an international academic competition organized for high school students from Turkic states and observer nations. TOAI is designed not only as a competition but as a long-term platform fostering academic collaboration, knowledge exchange, and technological innovation across the Turkic world.

1.2 Host Institution

TOAI 2026 is hosted by Yıldız Technical University (YTÜ), Istanbul, Türkiye. YTÜ serves as the official Host Institution and is responsible for providing campus facilities, laboratory infrastructure, academic support, and technical resources throughout the Olympiad.

1.3 Organizing Body

The Olympiad is organized by the TOAI Organizing Committee (hereinafter “the Organizing Committee”), operating under the coordination of the TOAI Turkey Coordination Office. The Organizing Committee retains full authority over the interpretation and enforcement of these regulations.

1.4 Objectives

The primary objectives of TOAI are:

- To identify and support outstanding young talent in the fields of artificial intelligence and related disciplines across Turkic states and observer nations.
- To foster regional academic and technological cooperation.
- To promote early specialization in AI, data science, and computational sciences among high school students.
- To build a sustainable, institutionalized platform for annual international collaboration in technology and innovation.

1.5 Official Language

The official language of TOAI is English. All competition tasks, official communications, announcements, and ceremonies are conducted in English. Delegations are responsible for ensuring their participants have sufficient English proficiency to engage with competition materials.

1.6 Governing Document

These regulations constitute the official and binding ruleset for TOAI 2026. In the event of any conflict between these regulations and any other document, communication, or verbal statement, these regulations shall prevail. The Organizing Committee reserves the right to amend these regulations prior to the start of the Olympiad, with all amendments communicated to delegations in writing no later than 14 days before the opening ceremony.

2 Article 2 — Abbreviations and Definitions

2.1 Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
AI	Artificial Intelligence
TOAI	Turkic Olympiad in Artificial Intelligence
YTÜ	Yıldız Technical University
HOC	Host Organizing Committee
ISC	International Scientific Committee

2.2 Definitions

- **Contestant** — A high school student participating in the competition.
- **Team Leader** — The adult responsible for the team and serving as the primary contact.
- **Host Institution** — Yıldız Technical University, Istanbul.
- **Full Member States** — Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Uzbekistan, Türkiye, Turkmenistan.
- **Observer Nations** — Nations invited to participate under specific conditions.

3 Article 3 — Organizational Structure

3.1 Organizing Committee

The Organizing Committee is the supreme governing body of TOAI. It is responsible for all strategic, logistical, and academic decisions related to the Olympiad. The Organizing Committee consists of the Executive President, President of the Board, Head of Media, Head of IT, Head of Sponsorship, and other Board Members.

3.2 Scientific Committee

The Scientific Committee is responsible for the design, review, and quality assurance of all competition tasks and evaluation procedures. Members of the Scientific Committee are appointed by the Organizing Committee and include faculty members from Yildiz Technical University, as well as invited subject-matter experts. All Scientific Committee members are bound by strict confidentiality agreements regarding competition content.

3.3 IT Department

The IT Department oversees all technical infrastructure, including competition platforms, laboratory environments, network connectivity, and hardware. Any technical issue during the competition must be reported immediately to the IT Department.

3.4 Media Department

The Media Department is responsible for managing the public presence, official communications, photography, videography, and social media coverage of the Olympiad.

3.5 Sponsorship Department

The Sponsorship Department manages relationships with official sponsors, handles funding, and coordinates the provision of prizes, scholarships, and material support for the Olympiad.

3.6 Jury

The Jury is responsible for the evaluation and scoring of all competition submissions. The Jury operates independently from delegations and its decisions on scoring are final, subject only to the formal appeals process defined in Article 11. The Jury is appointed by the Scientific Committee.

3.7 Team Leaders

Each participating country must designate an official Team Leader who serves as the primary point of contact between the delegation and the Organizing Committee. The Team Leader is responsible for ensuring that all members of their delegation comply with these regulations. Team Leaders may not interfere with competition tasks or communicate with participants during active competition sessions.

4 Article 4 — Eligibility & Participation Requirements

4.1 Eligible Participants

TOAI is open to high school students (grades 9–12 or equivalent) who are citizens of or permanently residing in a participating country as defined in Section 4.4. Participants must be enrolled in a high school at the time of registration.

4.2 Age Limit

Participants must not have reached their 20th birthday by the first day of the Olympiad (exact date to be announced). No exceptions to this age limit will be granted.

4.3 Prior Participation

A participant who has previously competed in TOAI as a student is eligible to compete again, provided they continue to meet all eligibility requirements. Participants who have enrolled in a university or equivalent higher education institution prior to the registration deadline are not eligible to compete as students.

4.4 Participating Countries

TOAI 2026 is open to delegations from the following categories:

- **Full Member States:** Azerbaijan, Hungary, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Uzbekistan, Türkiye, Turkmenistan.
- **Turkic Territories:** Autonomous or culturally Turkic regions and territories participating as distinct delegations.
- **Observer Nations:** Nations invited by the Organizing Committee based on regional and academic relevance. Observer nations participate under the same rules as full members unless otherwise specified.

Countries wishing to participate for the first time must submit an official expression of interest to the Organizing Committee no later than one month before the start of the Olympiad (exact date to be announced). This expression of interest must be accompanied by a letter from a recognized national institution (e.g., a ministry, university, or national olympiad committee).

4.5 Individual Participation

While the competition tasks and evaluations are entirely individual, participants cannot apply or compete independently. All participants must be selected and registered as part of an official national delegation (team). Once admitted, each participant competes independently and is individually evaluated; there are no team-based challenges or collaborative tasks.

4.6 Documentation

All participants must submit the following documents during registration:

- Valid passport or national identity card (copy).
- Official school enrollment certificate issued within the last 3 months.
- Birth certificate or equivalent document confirming date of birth.
- Signed participant consent form (including parental/guardian signature for participants under 18).
- Signed Code of Conduct declaration.

5 Article 5 — Country Quotas & Delegation Structure

5.1 Standard Quota

Each participating country is entitled to send a delegation consisting of:

- Up to 4 student participants
- 1 official Team Leader
- Up to 1 Deputy Team Leader (optional)

5.2 Observer Nation Quota

Observer nations are entitled to send a delegation of up to 4 student participants and 1 Team Leader.

5.3 Quota Adjustments

The Organizing Committee reserves the right to adjust quotas based on logistical capacity, venue constraints, or the number of registered countries.

5.4 Accompanying Persons

Team Leaders and Deputy Team Leaders are the only official accompanying persons recognized by the Organizing Committee. Additional guests or observers must seek separate accreditation from the Organizing Committee and are subject to a registration fee and availability constraints.

5.5 Substitutions

Substitutions of student participants may be made up to 30 days before the opening ceremony, subject to written approval from the Organizing Committee. Substitutions after this deadline are not permitted except in cases of documented medical emergency, at the sole discretion of the Organizing Committee.

6 Article 6 — Competition Format & Schedule

6.1 Format Overview

TOAI 2026 is conducted entirely in-person at Yıldız Technical University, Istanbul. There are no remote or online participation options for the competition rounds. All participants must be physically present for all competition sessions.

6.2 Olympiad Structure

Phase	Description	Duration
Arrival & Accreditation	Delegation registration, ID verification, and kit distribution	Day 1
Opening Ceremony	Official inauguration, participant orientation	Day 1
Competition Round I	Individual Programming Round	Day 2
Cultural & Academic Program	Workshops, campus tours, networking	Day 3
Competition Round II	Individual Programming Round	Day 4
Jury Deliberation	Scoring, verification, and results compilation	Day 5 (morning)
Closing Ceremony & Awards	Medal presentation, closing remarks	Day 5 (afternoon)
Departure	—	Day 6

6.3 Tentative Dates

TOAI 2026 is scheduled to take place in October 2026 in Istanbul. Exact dates will be confirmed and communicated to registered delegations no later than August, 2026.

6.4 Participant Schedule

A detailed daily schedule will be provided to all delegations upon arrival. Participants are required to be present for all scheduled competition sessions. Absence from any competition session without prior written authorization from the Organizing Committee will result in a score of zero for that session.

6.5 Competition Sessions

All competition sessions are held under examination conditions. Participants must arrive at the competition venues at least 15 minutes before the session start time. Late arrival of more than 15 minutes after the official start time will not be accommodated; the participant will be permitted to work for the remaining time, but no additional time will be granted.

6.6 Permitted Materials

Unless explicitly stated otherwise in the task description for a specific session, the following rules apply:

- Electronic devices (phones, tablets, smartwatches, laptops) are prohibited during competition sessions.
- Participants may use writing materials provided by the Organizing Committee.
- Programmable calculators are permitted only if explicitly authorized for a given session.
- Reference books, notes, and printed materials are not permitted unless explicitly provided as part of the task.
- Participants will only be permitted to access specifically whitelisted websites and resources during the competition. General internet access is strictly prohibited.

7 Article 7 — Competition Areas & Problem Structure

7.1 Disciplines

TOAI covers the following core disciplines:

- **Artificial Intelligence** — including machine learning concepts, neural networks, AI ethics, and applied AI problem solving.
- **Data Science** — including data analysis, statistical reasoning, data visualization, and interpretation.
- **Machine Learning** — including algorithm design, model evaluation, and optimization problems.
- **Robotics** — conceptual and applied problems related to robotic systems, sensors, and autonomous decision-making (where infrastructure permits).
- **Computational Sciences** — including algorithms, complexity theory, computational problem solving, and programming logic.

7.2 Translation Session

There will be a session before the rounds for team leaders to translate questions into their native language. Team leaders will not be able to communicate with competitors between these sessions and the competition rounds.

7.3 Programming Rounds (Round I & II)

There is no written exam in the Olympiad; both competition days (rounds) are entirely programming-based. Each programming round will be six hours long and will feature 2 to 3 programming questions. Access to large language models (LLMs), chatbots, coding assistants, or similar tools will not be permitted during the rounds, and all forms of communication are strictly prohibited. Participants will be provided with computers equipped with pre-specified software environments. The tasks will require participants to analyze data, develop or apply algorithms, and submit solutions within the allotted time. The permitted software and programming languages will be announced in the participant guide, which will be distributed no later than 30 days before the Olympiad.

7.4 Problem Confidentiality

All competition tasks are strictly confidential until officially released at the start of each session. Any participant who has prior knowledge of task content, or who is found to have communicated task content to others before or during the session, will be immediately disqualified.

7.5 Task Language

The original tasks are prepared in English. As established in the Translation Session, Team Leaders will translate the questions into their respective native languages prior to the rounds. Participants will receive access to both the original English text and the translated version. Where a task contains a genuine language ambiguity, participants may raise a written query during the first 15 minutes of the session, which will be addressed collectively to all participants by the presiding Jury member.

8 Article 8 — Scoring & Evaluation Criteria

8.1 Scoring Structure

Each competition round is scored independently. The final ranking is determined by the aggregate score across both rounds, weighted as follows:

- Round I: 50% of total score
- Round II: 50% of total score

8.2 Round Evaluation and Metrics

Scoring for Round II will be based exclusively on a private leaderboard metric, similar to the format used in Kaggle competitions. Participants will be able to monitor their public leaderboard scores during the rounds, while the final private scores will be announced at a later time. Evaluation metrics will consist of standard machine learning and data science metrics, such as Log Loss, F1-Score, RMSE, or Mean Average Precision, depending on the nature of the question.

8.3 Score Normalization

The scores achieved by participants will be normalized to ensure fair evaluation across varying question difficulties. Specifically, the normalization process will map the scores to a standard scale using a predefined baseline score (which is provided to all competitors) and the highest score achieved by any participant for that specific question. This ensures that the maximum possible points are awarded to the top performer, while other scores are scaled proportionally relative to the baseline.

8.4 Tie-Breaking

In the event of equal aggregate scores, the following tie-breaking criteria will be applied in order:

1. The score achieved in Round II.
2. The time of final submission in Round II (earlier submissions rank higher).

8.5 Score Verification

All scores are subject to internal verification by the Jury before official publication. Scores are considered final upon announcement at the Closing Ceremony, subject to the outcomes of any formal appeals submitted in accordance with Article 11.

8.6 Score Publication

Final scores and rankings will be published on the official TOAI website within 7 days of the conclusion of the Olympiad.

9 Article 9 — Awards & Prizes

9.1 Medal Categories

Medals are awarded based on participants' aggregate scores relative to the overall score distribution of all participants. The Jury determines medal thresholds after all scores are finalized, guided by the following approximate distribution targets:

- **Gold Medal:** 12.5% of participants
- **Silver Medal:** 25% of participants
- **Bronze Medal:** 50% of participants

The exact cutoff scores for each medal category are determined by the Jury and Scientific Committee after the competition. All participants who do not receive a medal but complete both competition rounds receive an official Certificate of Participation.

9.2 Honorable Mention

An Honorable Mention will be awarded to any participant who places in the top 50% in either round but does not qualify for a medal.

9.3 Award Ceremony

All medals and certificates are presented at the official Closing Ceremony. Recipients are expected to be present. In cases of documented necessity, a medal or certificate may be forwarded to the Team Leader for delivery to the recipient.

9.4 Prizes

Cash prizes, scholarship opportunities, and material prizes may be offered by official sponsors. Details of sponsor prizes will be announced no later than 30 days before the Olympiad. The Organizing Committee bears no financial liability for prizes sponsored by third parties.

10 Article 10 — Code of Conduct & Ethics

10.1 General Conduct

All participants, Team Leaders, and accompanying persons are expected to conduct themselves with integrity, respect, and professionalism throughout the Olympiad. TOAI is an international event that brings together students from diverse cultural backgrounds; all interactions must reflect mutual respect and cross-cultural sensitivity.

10.2 Academic Integrity

The following constitute violations of academic integrity and are strictly prohibited:

- Communicating with other participants, Team Leaders, or any external party during competition sessions by any means.
- Using unauthorized materials, devices, or resources during competition sessions.
- Accessing, copying, or reproducing competition task content before, during, or after sessions for unauthorized purposes.
- Submitting work that is not the participant's own.
- Attempting to obtain competition content through any unauthorized channel before sessions begin.

10.3 Behavioral Standards

The following are prohibited for all participants and delegation members throughout the duration of the Olympiad:

- Any form of harassment, discrimination, or intimidation based on nationality, ethnicity, gender, religion, or any other characteristic.
- Damage to or theft of property belonging to the Host Institution, Organizing Committee, or other participants.
- Consumption of alcohol or controlled substances on Olympiad premises.
- Any conduct that disrupts competition sessions, ceremonies, or official events.
- Unauthorized recording or photography of competition tasks or in secure areas.

10.4 Social Media & Communications

Participants and delegation members may post about the Olympiad on social media, provided that no competition task content, examination papers, or confidential information is disclosed. The Organizing Committee may request the removal of any post deemed to violate these rules.

10.5 Dress Code

Smart casual attire is required for the Opening and Closing Ceremonies. No specific dress code applies to competition sessions or cultural program activities beyond general standards of decency.

11 Article 11 — Appeals & Dispute Resolution

11.1 Right to Appeal

Team Leaders have the right to formally appeal any scoring decision on behalf of a participant in their delegation. Individual participants may not submit appeals directly; all appeals must be submitted by the Team Leader.

11.2 Grounds for Appeal

Valid grounds for appeal are limited to:

- A demonstrable scoring error (e.g., a correct answer marked as incorrect).
- A procedural irregularity that materially affected a participant's performance.
- A technical failure attributable to Olympiad infrastructure that was not remediated during the session.

Disagreement with the Jury's subjective evaluation of methodology, creativity, or approach does not constitute valid grounds for appeal.

11.3 Appeal Procedure

Appeals must be submitted in writing using the official Appeal Form, available from the Organizing Committee. Appeals must be submitted within 2 hours of the official publication of preliminary scores for the relevant round. Appeals submitted after this window will not be accepted. Each appeal must:

- Identify the participant and the specific score(s) being contested.
- State the precise grounds for the appeal with reference to the relevant regulation.
- Where applicable, provide supporting evidence (e.g., participant's original work, a specific task reference).

11.4 Appeal Fee

Each appeal must be accompanied by a non-refundable appeal deposit of USD 50, payable to the Organizing Committee. The deposit is refunded in full if the appeal is upheld.

11.5 Appeals Committee

All appeals are reviewed by an Appeals Committee composed of at least 3 members, including at least one member of the Scientific Committee and one member not directly involved in the scoring of the contested submission. The Appeals Committee's decision is final and binding.

11.6 Appeal Outcome

The Appeals Committee will issue a written decision within 24 hours of the appeal submission deadline. Decisions will be communicated to the relevant Team Leader. If an appeal is upheld, scores will be corrected, and rankings recalculated prior to the Closing Ceremony, where feasible.

12 Article 12 — Disqualification & Disciplinary Procedures

12.1 Grounds for Disqualification

A participant may be disqualified from the Olympiad for any of the following reasons:

- Violation of academic integrity as defined in Section 10.2.
- Submission of false or fraudulent registration documentation.
- Failure to meet eligibility requirements, discovered at any point during the Olympiad.
- Serious violation of the Code of Conduct as defined in Section 10.3.
- Refusal to comply with instructions from Jury members, invigilators, or the Organizing Committee during competition sessions.

12.2 Disqualification Procedure

Disqualification decisions are made by the Organizing Committee in consultation with the Scientific Committee and, where relevant, the Jury. Before a disqualification decision is finalized, the Team Leader will be informed and given an opportunity to provide a written response within 1 hour. The Organizing Committee's decision following this process is final.

12.3 Consequences of Disqualification

A disqualified participant's scores are annulled, and they are excluded from all rankings and awards. The participant is required to vacate the competition premises immediately upon disqualification. No refund of registration fees or travel expenses will be made to disqualified participants or their delegations.

12.4 Delegation Sanctions

If a Team Leader is found to have facilitated or encouraged a violation of these regulations, the Organizing Committee may impose sanctions on the delegation as a whole, including exclusion from future editions of TOAI.

12.5 Minor Infractions

Minor infractions of these regulations (e.g., late arrival to a session, minor procedural non-compliance) may result in a formal warning rather than disqualification. Repeated minor infractions may escalate to formal disciplinary review.

13 Article 13 — Liability & Data Protection

13.1 Health & Safety

The Organizing Committee and Host Institution take reasonable measures to ensure the safety and well-being of all participants and delegation members throughout the Olympiad. However, participants and delegations attend TOAI at their own risk. The Organizing Committee is not liable for personal injury, illness, loss, or damage to personal property occurring during the Olympiad except where directly caused by negligence on the part of the Organizing Committee or Host Institution.

13.2 Travel & Accommodation

Delegations are responsible for arranging and funding their own international travel and accommodation unless explicitly covered by TOAI scholarship or sponsorship agreements. The Organizing Committee will provide accommodation recommendations and may negotiate group rates with partner establishments, but assumes no liability for accommodation arrangements made independently by delegations.

13.3 Insurance

All participants and delegation members are strongly advised to obtain appropriate travel and health insurance prior to travel. The Organizing Committee does not provide insurance coverage for participants.

13.4 Data Collection

The Organizing Committee collects personal data from participants and delegation members for the purposes of registration, accreditation, communication, and administration of the Olympiad. Data is processed in accordance with applicable data protection regulations. By submitting a registration, participants and Team Leaders consent to the collection and processing of their personal data for these purposes.

13.5 Photography & Media

Official photographers and videographers appointed by the Organizing Committee will be present throughout the Olympiad. Images and footage may be used in TOAI's official communications, website, and promotional materials. Participants who do not consent to being photographed must notify the Organizing Committee in writing during registration.

13.6 Force Majeure

The Organizing Committee shall not be held liable for failure to fulfill its obligations under these regulations in the event of circumstances beyond its reasonable control, including but not limited to natural disasters, epidemics, government orders, or major infrastructure failures. In such cases, the Organizing Committee will communicate with delegations as promptly as possible regarding any changes to the Olympiad schedule or format.

14 Article 14 — Final Provisions

14.1 Interpretation

These regulations are interpreted exclusively by the Organizing Committee. In cases of ambiguity, the interpretation provided by the Organizing Committee shall be binding on all parties.

14.2 Languages of the Regulations

These regulations are published in English. In the event that a translated version is made available for informational purposes, the English version shall be the authoritative text.

14.3 Acceptance

Submission of a delegation registration constitutes unconditional acceptance of these regulations in their entirety by the Team Leader, on behalf of all members of their delegation.

14.4 Amendments

The Organizing Committee reserves the right to amend these regulations at any time prior to the commencement of the Olympiad. All amendments will be communicated to registered delegations in writing. Amendments become effective 14 days after notification unless an earlier effective date is required by exceptional circumstances, in which case delegations will be notified as promptly as possible.

TOAI Official Regulations — Version 1.0
Issued by the TOAI Organizing Committee
Directors

Hosted by Yıldız Technical University, Istanbul

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